HotTakes API Response Reference

Last updated November 7, 2026

This doc describes what each backend endpoint returns. Every endpoint is a GET request that returns JSON from the FastAPI backend (local dev: `http://127.0.0.1:8000`). Sample values are examples only; real responses contain real data.

Conventions

- Every `id` is a string, even when the source API uses numbers.
- Every result includes a `source` field: `tmdb`, `spotify`, or `twitch`.
- Missing images or optional values come back as `null`, so the frontend should check before rendering.
- Search endpoints return an array. Detail endpoints return a single object.
- All search results share a core shape (`id`, `title`, `imageUrl`, `source`), so one card component can display movies, TV shows, music, and games.

Errors

- **502** `{"detail": "Upstream API failed"}`: the external API (TMDB, Spotify, or Twitch) failed or rejected the request.
- **404** `{"detail": "Game not found"}`: only returned by the game details endpoint.
- **422**: FastAPI validation error, returned when a required parameter such as `q` is missing.

Endpoint summary

- `GET /api/search/movies?q=`: search movies
- `GET /api/movies/{movie_id}`: movie details
- `GET /api/search/tv?q=`: search TV shows
- `GET /api/tv/{tv_id}`: TV show details
- `GET /api/tv/{tv_id}/season/{season_number}`: episodes for one season
- `GET /api/search/music?q=`: search tracks
- `GET /api/music/{track_id}`: track details
- `GET /api/search/games?q=`: search games
- `GET /api/games/{game_id}`: game details

Movies (TMDB)

GET /api/search/movies?q=inception

Returns an array of up to 20 results (one page).

```json
```

```
[
  {
    "id": "27205",
    "title": "Inception",
    "subtitle": "2010",
    "overview": "A thief who steals corporate secrets through dreams is offered a
    "rating": 8.4,
    "imageUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w500/abc123.jpg",
    "source": "tmdb"
  }
]
```


- `subtitle`: release year, or an empty string if unknown.
- `rating`: average score from 0 to 10.
- `imageUrl`: poster image, or `null`.

Use case: the search box on the movies page. Call it after the user pauses typing, show each result as a card, and open the detail page with the card's `id` when it is clicked.

GET /api/movies/{movie_id}

Returns one object. Use the `id` from a search result.

```
json
```

```
{
  "id": "27205",
  "title": "Inception",
  "tagline": "Your mind is the scene of the crime.",
  "overview": "A thief who steals corporate secrets through dreams is offered a ch
  "releaseDate": "2010-07-15",
  "runtime": 148,
  "rating": 8.4,
  "genres": ["Action", "Science Fiction", "Adventure"],
  "posterUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w500/abc123.jpg",
  "backdropUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w1280/def456.jpg",
  "trailerKey": "YoutubeVideoID123",
  "cast": [
    {
      "name": "Leonardo DiCaprio",
      "character": "Cobb",
      "photoUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w185/ghi789.jpg"
    }
  ],
  "source": "tmdb"
}
```


- `runtime`: minutes.
- `trailerKey`: a YouTube video ID, or `null` if there is no trailer. Embed it with `https://www.youtube.com/embed/{trailerKey}`.
- `cast`: the first 10 billed actors. `photoUrl` can be `null`.
- `releaseDate`: `YYYY-MM-DD`.

Use case: the movie detail page. Show the backdrop and poster, the overview and genres, an embedded trailer when `trailerKey` is not `null`, and a row of cast members.

TV shows (TMDB)

GET /api/search/tv?q=breaking bad

Returns an array of up to 20 results. Same shape as movie search, with `subtitle` holding the first air year.

json

```
[
  {
    "id": "1396",
    "title": "Breaking Bad",
    "subtitle": "2008",
    "overview": "A high school chemistry teacher turns to making and selling drugs
    "rating": 8.9,
    "imageUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w500/jkl012.jpg",
    "source": "tmdb"
  }
]
```


Use case: the search box on the TV page, using the same card component as movies. Remember that each result is a TV show, so a click goes to `/api/tv/{tv_id}` and not the movie route.

GET /api/tv/{tv_id}

Returns one object.

json

```
{
  "id": "1396",
  "title": "Breaking Bad",
  "tagline": "Remember my name",
  "overview": "A high school chemistry teacher turns to making and selling drugs a
  "firstAirDate": "2008-01-20",
  "lastAirDate": "2013-09-29",
  "status": "Ended",
  "numberOfSeasons": 5,
  "numberOfEpisodes": 62,
  "rating": 8.9,
  "genres": ["Drama", "Crime"],
  "networks": ["AMC"],
  "creators": ["Vince Gilligan"],
  "posterUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w500/jkl012.jpg",
  "backdropUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w1280/mno345.jpg",
  "trailerKey": "YoutubeVideoID456",
  "seasons": [
    {
      "seasonNumber": 1,
      "name": "Season 1",
      "episodeCount": 7,
      "airDate": "2008-01-20",
      "posterUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w500/pqr678.jpg"
    }
  ],
  "cast": [
    {
      "name": "Bryan Cranston",
      "character": "Walter White",
      "photoUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w185/stu901.jpg"
    }
  ],
  "source": "tmdb"
}
```


- `status`: for example `Ended` or `Returning Series`.
- `seasons`: some shows include a "Season 0" for specials. The frontend may want to hide it.
- Movie and TV IDs are separate. The same number can refer to a movie and an unrelated show, so the frontend must remember which type a result is.

Use case: the show page. Show the overview, network, status, and number of seasons, with a season list that lets the user pick which season's episodes to view.

GET /api/tv/{tv_id}/season/{season_number}

Returns the episodes for one season.

json


```
{
  "seasonNumber": 1,
  "name": "Season 1",
  "overview": "",
  "episodes": [
    {
      "episodeNumber": 1,
      "name": "Pilot",
      "overview": "A chemistry teacher makes a life-changing decision.",
      "airDate": "2008-01-20",
      "runtime": 58,
      "rating": 8.3,
      "stillUrl": "https://image.tmdb.org/t/p/w300/vwx234.jpg"
    }
  ]
}
```


- `stillUrl`: an episode screenshot, or `null`.
- `runtime`: minutes, and can be `null`.

Use case: the episode list on a show page. Load it when the user picks a season, so the page does not fetch every season up front.

Music (Spotify)

GET /api/search/music?q=daft punk

Returns an array of up to 10 tracks. Spotify caps search at 10 results per request for new apps.

json

```
[
  {
    "id": "2cGxRwrMyEAp8dEbuZaVv6",
    "title": "Get Lucky",
    "subtitle": "Daft Punk, Pharrell Williams, Nile Rodgers",
    "album": "Random Access Memories",
    "imageUrl": "https://i.scdn.co/image/abc123",
    "previewUrl": null,
    "spotifyUrl": "https://open.spotify.com/track/2cGxRwrMyEAp8dEbuZaVv6",
    "source": "spotify"
  }
]
```


- `subtitle`: artist names joined with commas.
- `previewUrl`: a 30-second audio clip, but Spotify returns `null` for many tracks. Hide the player when it is empty and fall back to `spotifyUrl`.

Use case: the music search box. Show album art, title, and artists on each card, and link to `spotifyUrl` for playback.

GET /api/music/{track_id}

Returns one object.

json


```
{
  "id": "2cGxRwrMyEAp8dEbuZaVv6",
  "title": "Get Lucky",
  "artists": ["Daft Punk", "Pharrell Williams", "Nile Rodgers"],
  "album": "Random Access Memories",
  "releaseDate": "2013-05-17",
  "durationMs": 369626,
  "imageUrl": "https://i.scdn.co/image/abc123",
  "previewUrl": null,
  "spotifyUrl": "https://open.spotify.com/track/2cGxRwrMyEAp8dEbuZaVv6",
  "source": "spotify"
}
```


- `durationMs`: length in milliseconds (divide by 1000 for seconds).
- `releaseDate`: Spotify sometimes returns only a year (`2013`) or a year and month (`2013-05`), so don't assume a full date.

Use case: the track page. Show the title, artists, album, release date, and duration, with an audio player only when `previewUrl` is present.

Games (Twitch)

GET /api/search/games?q=zelda

Returns an array of up to 10 games.

```json
[
  {
    "id": "110758",
    "title": "The Legend of Zelda: Tears of the Kingdom",
    "imageUrl": "https://static-cdn.jtvnw.net/ttv-boxart/110758-285x380.jpg",
    "source": "twitch"
  }
]
```

Use case: the game search box. Show the cover art and title on each card, and open the game page with the card's `id`.

GET /api/games/{game_id}

Returns one object, or a 404 if the game is not found.

```json
{
  "id": "110758",
  "title": "The Legend of Zelda: Tears of the Kingdom",
  "imageUrl": "https://static-cdn.jtvnw.net/ttv-boxart/110758-285x380.jpg",
  "igdbId": "119388",
  "source": "twitch"
}
```

- Twitch only provides the game name and cover art. There is no description, release date, or rating.
- `igdbId`: the matching ID in IGDB, which can be used later to fetch richer game details.

Use case: the game page header, showing the cover art and title. Use `igdbId` later to pull richer details such as a description and release date.

Notes for the frontend

- Search results from all four sources share `id`, `title`, `imageUrl`, and `source`. `subtitle` is present for movies, TV, and music but not games.
- Always null-check `imageUrl`, `trailerKey`, and `previewUrl` before rendering.
- Search is one request per query. Wait until the user stops typing before calling it, to avoid rate limits.
- TMDB requires an attribution notice on the site: "This product uses the TMDB API but is not endorsed or certified by TMDB."